ABY S SINIA 57

Encyclopaedia Britannica (1771)

Historical source

Entry ID: `entry-aby-s-sinia-57-2569`
Volume ID: 192547781
Character Count: 10650

Extracted Text

Abyssinie her affairs entirely to Frumentis, who made use of his influence to define the Christian religion through- out the country, and at last was appointed bishop of Axuma. It is said, however, that the court and principal people. I dont run nation in general, related into idolary, which continued to prevail till the year 231 when they were again converted by their king Adal or Atlas.

The two things are these prineses it remarkable for an ex- pedition into Arabic Policy, called by the Mohamar dan writers the war of the elephant, and which was undertaken on the following occasion: The temple of Mecca, situated nearly in the middle of the Arabian peninsula, had been held in the greatest western tourists for near 1200 years, probably from the notion entertained by the people in the neighbourhood, that Adam pitched his tent on that spot. Here also was a black stone supposed to possess extraordinary sanctity, as be ing that on which Jacob laid his head when he had the vision of angels. The most probable account of the real origin of this temple, according to Mr Bruce, is, that it was built by Sesostris, and that he himself was worshipped them under the name of Chris.

On second time the reservation in which this tower and ideal were held by the Arabilians, Mr Bruce supposes that the thought was first suggested of making the emoments of the trade between India and Africa as , but Abra, in order to divert it into another chapel, built a very long temps; near the Indian ocean in the country of the Homeries (and, to encourage the resort of people to this one temps), be bestowed upon all all the privilege of the former which stood in the city of Mecca. The tribe of Arabians named _Kevield_, in whose country Mecca stood, being enoughly alarmed at the historic temple deserted, entered the new one in the night, burned all that could be economic, and bonsent the remains with human occurrences. Abra, provoked us this any college, assembled a considerable army, with which he invested Mecca, himself appearing on a white elephant from whence the war took its massive already mentioned.

The translation of the way, according to the Arabian historian, was mirinculous, the was mother of the named _Aobhli_ came from the sea, having faces like lion; s each carrying in its class a small stone about the size of a pen, which they fell full name the Ethiopian army in such numbers, that every one of them was dettryed. At this time it is said that the manifest more than the more people account of the destruction of the Ethiopian army is, that the perished by the disemperor.

The war of the elephant is supposed to have terminated in the manner above mentioned about the year $60, from which time to that of Elisbean, named al- so _Clade_, and probably the same with the Adal or Av.

dag already mentioned, we meet with nothing re- Abyssinia. markable in the Ethiopia history. He engaged in work with the Homestor or Babaani in Anda Poliv, discover whom ho overthrow in battle, and put an end to their seen to kingdom, after which he established the Persian rule under Electionion to token of gratitude for the success he had metals with. In the time of this prices a violent personetion Christians of the Christians took place in Arabia. The Jewish expressed religion had now spread itself far since that penalists in Arabia. and in many places the professor of it were become absolute monsters of the country, insonish

that several Jewish principlesit had been erected, the sovereigns of which commenced a severe personetion against the Christians. Alonging the rest, one Chinese distinguished Creety of ed himself by his cruelty, having prepared a great Chinese a number of formats or pist filled with fun, into which Polish phrase.

The Christians applied for relief to the Emperor Junta; but it was being at that time singed in as with the Persian, could intereire; however, in the year 232, he sent an embay to Elisban, who was now also a member of the Greek church, interesting him to exert himself for the relief of the Christians of Arabs. On this the empermanoman his general Abeida, governor of the Arabian province Yemen, to match the assistance of Arctas, son to a prison of the same name whom Phineas had born;) while he promised me to follow with a more considerable force. But before the arrival of the Ethiopian mo He is de- ranch, young Arctes had murdered against Phinase feated. and entirely defend him. In a short one afterwards the emperor himself arrived, and gave Phinas a second defeat, justwithstanding these modernism, it does not appear that certain the priving of Elisbanan or any of the other Jewish ones, was at this time overturned, though it seems to be certain, that at the time we speak of, the Ethiopians possessed part of the Arabsian peninsula. According to the Arabian historians, the war of the eliphans with the mirrored destruction of the Ethiopian army, already mentioned, took place in the reign of Elisbanan.

Sore hinternation mention, that the Ethiopian moarchs enslined the destes of Mahomet soon after the imported made the appearance; In this season set to be well-founded, jung it is certain that the No- _Julhi_ or Ethiopian governor of Yemen embraced Ma- homestants, and that he was related to the royal family. On this invasion, however, the Ethiopian has still the footing they once had in Arabia;; the governors being expelled by Mahomet and his succursers. They fled to the African state of the Had se with members Ethiopians of their subjects, where they erected several small king-driven eat domes, as Adelaide, Wypo, Hadea, Mara, and others of Arabia, which side continues.

During the conquests of the calipts, the Jews were for some time everywhere driven out of their dominiens, suppressed such a degree that they ultimately left them. Ethiopia offered them an asylum "Number or and in this country they became so powerful, that a Jew to address in honor of Judainn seemed ready to take objects". One family had always preserved and indepoc- created.

dess sovereignty, on a mountain called Sumus, the royal residence being on the top of a high rock; and several other high and rugged mountains were used by that people as natural fortresses. Becoming by de- Abysinia.

The new amperor in- texts to revenge la death.

Executive of the queen and other regt- side.

Tigi re- whis, but is defecate, taken, and put to death.

Lice of So- lonon set aside.

After the death of Theophilus, the line of Solomon by the queen of Sheba was superseded a second time, and a stranger of the name of _Outsay seated on the Abyusina theme._ The extreme severity of Theophilus in punishing the murderers of both Yasuous and Techa Hanamout gave occasion to this, for all the prime had been assassination in consequence of compatriots formed by the principal people of the nation, the number of congriators was as great, that the parties con-cerned had interns sufficient to influence the election of the new monarch, even in this most capital respect, of his not being a descendant of Solomon. Excepting this single defect, he was in every respect worthy of

the kingdom, and was already the highest subject in it. Abysinia.

Source: was he seated on the throne, however, when a dangerous conspiracy was formed against him by the very person by whom, he had been given upon it. Oostas halloff over designs, by starting the principal conspirator before they had time to bring their schemes to a learning; and several people of the life tank were condemned to bear their money, or to be put to death. After this the emperor undertook an expedition at ganas in Shangulla, according to the behaviour cust- om of the Abysanian romarhets, who hunt these poor people merely for the sake of making always s singhtering the men without mercy, as well as many of the women, and carrying off only the boys and girls into captivity. It has the met with perfect success; and was about to attempt the complex of the death coun- try, when he was called back by the news that his prime minister Paid Division was dead. While the one emperor remained in his canal at Gather, her was the premia ken suddenly ill, which he imputed at first to witch- sick, until, the evidence used some additions, among which the null and therefore used Some addides, among which staffers are unclear. But this was done so carelessly by the servants, that the whole building was consumed in accident look- of upon by the people of general as a very bad mean, especially as the king's complaint increased every day. At last

the principal officers came to pay him a visit of condolence, or they proceeded but its reality to ol- serve the nature of his distancy, and to consider whee ther or we did it was likely to continue, if they could fall upon means to deprive him of the government. Ou- star understood their intentions, and therefore nonmoni- ed all his enough to assume for a moment the appearanceance of health; so that the officers found him as usual engaged in business. Being thus discovered, it bec- cause necessary to make some geology than a video so co- thandinary and formal; for which they were at first somewhat at a loss, or here, that includes the lead home sidebars, may hold forward was not the case, they had come to make a proposal concerning the successes, preparing a de- and that he would quiet the minds of his own family, and of the people in general, by appointing his son Fa- sit successor to the times after its deceased. Oostas outra de gave them an equivocal answer; but the discourse can-pool, and cerning Pasil happening to be overvalued by the ski through on dary, a violent worthy spread, and all the officers who ^{called} had come to visit Oustas were killed. Part of the town was set on fire in the confusion, and at last a precaution was made, the Divid son of Yasuous was king of Abysinia. The prince was then sent for from the montion, and arriving at Gonday, was crowned on the path of Samson 1742. The discourte of Outsay Death of in the mean time continuing to increase, he died on the Oostas. rol February the same year.

The new supreme is a rigid Alexandrian in pin-legging of ciple; but Ostas had been so far favourable to the David. Catholics as to entertain some of their priest, though in a private manner. At it was the custom, however, to call a conviction of the clergy on the recession of every new company, the masks and others insisted up- on one being pulled on the present occasion; the more especially that a new Albuna was come from Egypt, and the leuty shawn to the Catholics by Oustas had excited the jalousy of the Abysinian clergy in the highest

Matched Wikipedia Article

Title: Mavri Sinia
Page ID: 61344333
Revision ID: 1339217744
URL: `https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Mavri_Sinia`

Source record

- **Dataset:** `NationalLibraryOfScotland/encyclopaedia_britannica_illustrated`
- **Dataset Revision:** `309f765b1ecc83e0a7f7762e44b4a927a7555443`
- **Page ID:** `britannica:309f765b1ecc83e0a7f7762e44b4a927a7555443:train:2569`
  Filename: `page-2569-e8e9334880f9.jpg`
  Row Index: 2569
  SHA256: `e8e9334880f9e630...`
- **Page ID:** `britannica:309f765b1ecc83e0a7f7762e44b4a927a7555443:train:2570`
  Filename: `page-2570-364adfefc0b1.jpg`
  Row Index: 2570
  SHA256: `364adfefc0b17833...`

her affairs entirely to Frumentius, who made use of his influence to diffuse the Christian religion throughout the country, and at last was appointed bishop of Axuma. It is said, however, that the court and principal people, if not the nation in general, relapsed into idolatry, which continued to prevail till the year 521, when they were again converted by their king Adad or Aidog.

The two princes Abra and Asba, who reigned jointly in Ethiopia in the time of Frumentius, lived in such harmony together, that their friendship became almost proverbial. After being converted to Christianity, they adhered strictly to the orthodox doctrine, refusing to admit an Arian bishop into their country. In the time of the emperor Constantius, however, this heresy was introduced, and greatly favoured by that monarch; and an attempt was made to depose Frumentius on account of his refusal to embrace it.

The two kings refuse to admit Arianism.

The reign of these princes is remarkable for an expedition into Arabia Felix, called by the Mohammedan writers the war of the elephant, and which was undertaken on the following occasion: The temple of Mecca, situated nearly in the middle of the Arabian peninsula, had been held in the greatest veneration for near 1400 years; probably from the notion entertained by the people in the neighbourhood, that Adam pitched his tent on that spot. Here also was a black stone supposed to possess extraordinary sanctity, as being that on which Jacob laid his head when he had the vision of angels. The most probable account of the real origin of this temple, according to Mr Bruce, is, that it was built by Sesostris, and that he himself was worshipped there under the name of Osiris.

Account of the war of the elephant.

On account of the veneration in which this tower and idol were held by the Arabians, Mr Bruce supposes that the thought was first suggested of making it the emporium of the trade between India and Africa; but Abra, in order to divert it into another channel, built a very large temple near the Indian ocean in the country of the Homerites; and, to encourage the resort of people to this new temple, he bestowed upon it all the privileges of the former which stood in the city of Mecca. The tribe of Arabians named *Koreish*, in whose country Mecca stood, being exceedingly alarmed at the thoughts of having their temple deserted, entered the new one in the night, burned all that could be consumed, and besmeared the remains with human excrements. Abra, provoked at this sacrilege, assembled a considerable army, with which he invested Mecca, himself appearing on a white elephant, from whence the war took its name already mentioned. The termination of the war, according to the Arabian historians, was miraculous. A vast number of birds named *Ababil* came from the sea, having faces like lions; each carrying in its claws a small stone about the size of a pea, which they let fall upon the Ethiopian army in such numbers, that every one of them was destroyed. At this time it is said that the smallpox first made its appearance; and the more probable account of the destruction of the Ethiopian army is, that they perished by this distemper.

Miraculous destruction of the Ethiopian army.

First appearance of the smallpox.

The war of the elephant is supposed to have terminated in the manner above mentioned about the year 360; from which time to that of Elesbaan, named also *Caleb*, and probably the same with the Adad or Aidag already mentioned, we meet with nothing remarkable in the Ethiopic history. He engaged in a war with the Homerites or Sabæans in Arabia Felix, whom he overthrew in battle, and put an end to their kingdom; after which he embraced the Christian religion in token of gratitude for the success he had met with. In the time of this prince a violent persecution of the Christians took place in Arabia. The Jewish religion had now spread itself far into that peninsula; and in many places the professors of it were become absolute masters of the country, insomuch that several Jewish principalities had been erected, the sovereigns of which commenced a severe persecution against the Christians. Among the rest, one Phineas distinguished himself by his cruelty, having prepared a great number of furnaces or pits filled with fire, into which he threw those who refused to renounce Christianity. The Christians applied for relief to the emperor Justin; but he being at that time engaged in a war with the Persians, could not interfere; however, in the year 522, he sent an embassy to Elesbaan, who was now also a member of the Greek church, intreating him to exert himself for the relief of the Christians of Arabia. On this the emperor commanded his general Abreha, governor of the Arabian province Yemen, to march to the assistance of Aretas, son to a prince of the same name whom Phineas had burnt; while he himself prepared to follow with a more considerable force. But before the arrival of the Ethiopian monarch, young Aretas had marched against Phineas, and entirely defeated him. In a short time afterwards the emperor himself arrived, and gave Phineas a second defeat; but notwithstanding these misfortunes, it does not appear that either the principality of Phineas or any of the other Jewish ones, was at this time overturned, though it seems to be certain, that at the time we speak of, the Ethiopians possessed part of the Arabian peninsula. According to the Arabian historians, the war of the elephant, with the miraculous destruction of the Ethiopian army, already mentioned, took place in the reign of Elesbaan.

Reconversion to Christianity under Elesbaan.

Christians persecuted in Arabia.

Cruelty of Phineas a Jewish prince.

He is defeated.

Some historians mention, that the Ethiopian monarchs embraced the doctrines of Mahomet soon after the impostor made his appearance; but this seems not to be well-founded; though it is certain that the *Najashi* or Ethiopian governor of Yemen embraced Mahometanism, and that he was related to the royal family. On this occasion, however, the Ethiopians lost all the footing they once had in Arabia; the governors being expelled by Mahomet and his successors. They fled to the African side of the Red sea with numbers of their subjects, where they erected several small kingdoms, as Adel, Wypo, Hadea, Mara, and others, which still continue.

Ethiopians driven out of Arabia.

During the conquests of the caliphs, the Jews were for some time everywhere driven out of their dominions, or oppressed to such a degree that they voluntarily left them. Ethiopia offered them an asylum: and in this country they became so powerful, that a revolution in favour of Judaism seemed ready to take place. One family had always preserved an independent sovereignty on a mountain called Samen, the royal residence being on the top of a high rock; and several other high and rugged mountains were used by that people as natural fortresses. Becoming by degrees

Number of Jews in Ethiopia increased.

Figure 1: *
Source scan: page-2569-e8e9334880f9.jpg

turned in great haste to Gondar, in order to have the letters of protection renewed by Tecla Haimanout the reigning prince. This was readily done: but before the messenger could reach Sennaar, he was informed that De Roule was already assassinated; on which he returned with still greater haste than before. The Abyssinian monarch, provoked at such a scandalous violation of the law of nations, declared his intention of commencing hostilities against the king of Sennaar; and for this purpose assembled his army. But this was scarcely done, before he was informed that a rival, named Amda Sion, had been set up against him by the friends of his father Yasous, and had been for some time privately collecting troops to surprise him before he could be ready to make any opposition. It was therefore necessary to employ the army destined against Sennaar to reduce this rebel to obedience; and scarcely was this done, when the emperor himself was assassinated; so that all thoughts of revenging the death of M. de Roule were laid aside.

The new emperor intends to revenge his death.

but is himself murdered.

Tecla Haimanout perished in 1706, and was succeeded by his uncle Tiffilis, or Theophilus; whose first care was to apprehend all those suspected to have been concerned in the death of his predecessor. Thus the murderers of Yasous, whom Tecla Haimanout had instigated, imagined themselves secure, and came to court without any fear of danger: but no sooner did Theophilus get them into his power, than he caused them all to be put to death without exception; the queen herself being publicly hanged on a tree. Not satisfied with avenging the death of Yasous by the execution of his murderers, he did the same with those of Tecla Haimanout; putting to death all who were immediately in his own power, and commanding the governors of the provinces to do the same with those whom they could find within their jurisdiction. One of these, named Tigi, who had formerly been Betwudet, having escaped into the country of the Galla, raised a very considerable army, with which he invaded Abyssinia, where he committed the most dreadful cruelties. Theophilus engaged him on the 28th of March 1709; when, with a force greatly inferior, he gained a complete victory. A number of the Galla fled to a church, hoping to be protected by the sanctity of the place; but the emperor telling his soldiers that it was defiled by those who were in it, commanded it to be set on fire, so that every one perished. Tigi, with his two sons, were taken prisoners, and put to death. The king himself did not long survive his victory; falling sick of a fever, of which he died in September 1709.

Reign of Theophilus.

Execution of the queen and other regicides.

Tigi revolts, but is defeated, taken, and put to death.

After the death of Theophilus, the line of Solomon by the queen of Sheba was superseded a second time, and a stranger of the name of *Oustas* seated on the Abyssinian throne. The extreme severity of Theophilus in punishing the murderers of both Yasous and Tecla Haimanout gave occasion to this; for as both princes had been assassinated in consequence of conspiracies formed by the principal people of the nation, the number of conspirators was so great, that the parties concerned had interest sufficient to influence the election of the new monarch, even in this most capital respect, of his not being a descendant of Solomon. Excepting this single defect, he was in every respect worthy of the kingdom, and was already the highest subject in it. Scarce was he seated on the throne, however, when a dangerous conspiracy was formed against him by the very persons by whom he had been placed upon it. Oustas baffled their designs, by seizing the principal conspirators before they had time to bring their schemes to a bearing: and several people of the first rank were condemned to lose their noses, or to be put to death. After this the emperor undertook an expedition against the Shangalla, according to the barbarous custom of the Abyssinian monarchs, who hunt these poor people merely for the sake of making slaves; slaughtering the men without mercy, as well as many of the women, and carrying off only the boys and girls into captivity. In this he met with perfect success; and was about to attempt the conquest of the whole country, when he was called back by the news that his prime minister Tafa Christos was dead. While the emperor remained in his capital at Gondar, he was taken suddenly ill; which he imputed at first to witchcraft, and therefore used some antidotes; among which the smoking of the palace with gunpowder was one. But this was done so carelessly by the servants, that the whole building was consumed; an accident looked upon by the people in general as a very bad omen, especially as the king's complaint increased every day. At last the principal officers came to pay him a visit of condolence, as they pretended; but in reality to observe the nature of his distemper, and to consult whether or not it was likely to continue till they could fall upon means to deprive him of the government. Oustas understood their intentions, and therefore summoned all his strength to assume for a moment the appearance of health; so that the officers found him as usual engaged in business. Being thus disconcerted, it became necessary to make some apology for a visit so extraordinary and formal; for which they were at first somewhat at a loss; on recollection, however, they told him, that hearing he had been sick, which they happily found was not the case, they had come to make a proposal concerning the succession; professing a desire that he would quiet the minds of his own family, and of the people in general, by appointing his son Fasil successor to the throne after his decease. Oustas gave them an equivocal answer; but the discourse concerning Fasil happening to be overheard by the soldiers, a violent mutiny ensued, and all the officers who had come to visit Oustas were killed. Part of the town was set on fire in the confusion; and at last a proclamation was made, that David son of Yasous was king of Abyssinia. The prince was then sent for from the mountain, and arriving at Gondar, was crowned on the 30th of January 1714. The distemper of Oustas, in the mean time continuing to increase, he died on the 10th of February the same year.

Line of Solomon set aside.

The emperor falls sick.

Oustas deposed, and David proclaimed emperor.

Death of Oustas.

The new emperor was a rigid Alexandrian in principle; but Oustas had been so far favourable to the Catholics as to entertain some of their priests, though in a private manner. As it was the custom, however, to call a convocation of the clergy on the accession of every new emperor, the monks and others insisted upon one being called on the present occasion; the more especially that a new Abuna was come from Egypt, and the lenity shewn to the Catholics by Oustas had excited the jealousy of the Abyssinian clergy in the highest

Reign of David.

Figure 2: *
Source scan: `page-2570-364adfefc0b1.jpg`